



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 1

PART 1

You will hear a woman who works at a local rowing club helping a man to register for a membership. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker A: Good morning, welcome to the Riverside Rowing Club. How can I help you today?

Speaker B: Hi there, I'd like to register for a membership, please. I saw your flyer at the sports shop.

Speaker A: Great! I can help you fill out the application form right now. First, can I get your full name?

Speaker B: Yes, it's Michael Thorne. That's T-H-O-R-N-E.

Speaker A: Got it. And what type of membership would you like? We have monthly, annual, and weekend-only options.

Speaker B: I think the annual membership is best for me, as I plan to come regularly.

Speaker A: Perfect. Annual membership. Now, could you tell me your date of birth?

Speaker B: It's the fourteenth of September, nineteen eighty-nine.

Speaker A: September fourteenth, nineteen eighty-nine. Excellent. And what is your current address?

Speaker B: I live at forty-two Priory Street, in Oakwood. Priory is spelled P-R-I-O-R-Y.

Speaker A: Okay, forty-two Priory Street. Next, I'll need a contact number for you.

Speaker B: Sure, my mobile number is 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-8-5.

Speaker A: Let me write that down. 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-8-5. Is that correct?

Speaker B: Yes, that's it.

Speaker A: Great. We also require an emergency contact name and relationship.

Speaker B: You can put down my brother, Donald Thorne.

Speaker A: Donald, spelled D-O-N-A-L-D?

Speaker B: Yes, that's right.

Speaker A: Do you have any medical conditions we should be aware of?

Speaker B: Well, I have mild asthma, but it's very well controlled and I don't usually need to take any medication for it during exercise.

Speaker A: Okay, I'll note down asthma but no medication needed. Do you have any previous rowing experience?

Speaker B: Yes, I actually rowed for my college team when I was at university about ten years ago, but I haven't done much since then.

Speaker A: No problem at all, college team experience is great. We have sessions at different times of the day. Do you have a preferred session time?

Speaker B: Mornings would work best for me before I go to work.

Speaker A: Okay, mornings it is. We can get you started quite soon. The next group begins on the eighteenth of June.

Speaker B: The eighteenth of June is perfect.

Speaker A: Excellent. Lastly, I will process your payment. Once done, it will generate a payment reference number.

Speaker B: Great, I'll pay by card.

Speaker A: Okay, payment accepted. Your payment reference number is 8-2-4-9-1-0.

Speaker B: Let me just note that down... 8-2-4-9-1-0. Got it, thank you!

Speaker A: Excellent. You're all set. We look forward to seeing you on the water!

This is the end of Part 1.

PART 2

You will hear a library manager talking about the upcoming renovations at the Oakridge Public Library. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening, everyone. My name is Helen, and as the chief librarian here at Oakridge, I am delighted to share some exciting news about the upcoming renovation of our public library. This project has been in the planning stages for over three years, and work is finally scheduled to begin on Monday, the fifth of August. The library will be closed to the public for a total of six weeks, with our grand reopening scheduled for the middle of September.

Speaker A: Our main goal for this renovation is to create a more functional space. While many residents suggested we expand the physical building, our budget unfortunately didn't allow for that. Instead, we are focusing on rearranging the interior to accommodate more public computers, which have seen a massive increase in demand over the last year. We are also upgrading our ancient heating system to make the building more environmentally friendly.

Speaker A: During the closure, we want to minimize disruption to our members. Therefore, we have arranged for a mobile library van to visit the town square every Tuesday and Thursday afternoon. You will be able to return books there and collect items that you have reserved online. Unfortunately, we cannot offer computer access in the van, but the community center down the road has agreed to let library cardholders use their computer lab for free during this period.

Speaker A: One of the biggest changes will be in the children's section. We are completely redesigning this area to make it more interactive. The old wooden tables will be replaced with colorful, modular furniture that can be easily rearranged for storytelling sessions. We are also installing a soft play carpet and three touchscreen educational tablets. Best of all, thanks to a generous private donation, we are adding a brand new sensory alcove for children with additional needs.

Speaker A: Finally, I'd like to talk about how you can get involved. We are seeking volunteers to help us pack up the books before the building work starts. We also need volunteers on the reopening day to act as guides. Additionally, we have launched a fundraising drive. We aren't asking for old books, as our storage is full, but we are looking for donations of board games for our new Friday social club, as well as plants to decorate the study area. If you can help, please speak to me afterwards.

Speaker A: Now, let me give you some details on the specific volunteer roles we need to fill during the transition. For the packing phase, which takes place in the last week of July,

we need people who are physically fit because it involves a lot of lifting. You will be placing books into heavy cardboard boxes. We also need people to help with sorting. This involves checking the condition of our books and deciding which ones should be sold at our upcoming book fair. You will need to have a keen eye for detail for this task, as we want to keep our collection in top shape.

Speaker A: On the reopening day itself, we need volunteers to help at the welcome desk. Your main duty will be handing out the new library brochures. We are also looking for a few enthusiastic people to run the refreshment stand, serving tea and cake to our visitors. If you are good with technology, we could also use some assistance in the computer lab, helping users navigate the new booking system. All volunteers will receive a free library bag and a voucher for a local café.

This is the end of Part 2.



PART 3

You will hear two university students, Liam and Sophie, discussing their joint research project with their tutor, Professor Davies. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker C: Come in, Liam, Sophie. Please, take a seat. How is your research project on urban green spaces coming along?

Speaker A: Thanks, Professor Davies. We've completed our initial literature review, but we're having a few disagreements on how to narrow down our hypothesis.

Speaker B: Yes, Liam wants to focus purely on the psychological benefits of parks, whereas I think we should also look at the economic impacts, like property values around green areas.

Speaker C: That's a common dilemma. While economic impacts are fascinating, you have to remember you only have three months. I'd strongly suggest sticking to one clear dimension. Psychological well-being is highly relevant right now, and there is plenty of data available.

Speaker A: I agree. If we try to cover economic factors too, the project might become too broad and lose its focus.

Speaker B: Alright, you've convinced me. We'll stick to the psychological benefits of urban parks. But how should we collect our primary data? I suggested online surveys because they allow us to reach a much larger number of people very quickly, but Liam thinks face-to-face interviews in the parks would yield better insights.

Speaker C: Both methods have merits. Online surveys let you gather a larger volume of responses quickly, but they can suffer from low completion rates. Face-to-face interviews offer depth, but they are time-consuming and weather-dependent. Why not do a hybrid approach? Use a short questionnaire for park visitors and follow up with a few deeper interviews over the phone.

Speaker A: That sounds like a sensible compromise. We could design a questionnaire that takes no more than five minutes to complete.

Speaker B: Yes, and we can hand them out at three different parks in the city to get a representative sample of residents.

Speaker C: Good idea. Now, what about your plan for analyzing the data? Have you decided which statistical software to use?

Speaker A: We were thinking of using SPSS, as we both learned the basics in our methodology class last semester.

Speaker B: Actually, Liam, I was talking to some postgraduate students who recommended R instead. They said it's much more powerful for data visualization.

Speaker C: R is certainly powerful, but it has a very steep learning curve if you haven't used it before. Given your tight deadline, I'd advise you to stick with SPSS. You already know how to navigate it, which will save you valuable time.

Speaker A: That makes sense. We don't want to spend weeks just trying to learn how to code.

Speaker B: True. Let's stick to SPSS then. Professor, we also need to decide which chapters of our final report we are each going to draft. We want to divide the workload fairly.

Speaker C: Let's look at your outline. You have five main sections: the Introduction, the Literature Review, the Methodology, the Data Analysis, and the Discussion and Conclusion. How do you plan to split them?

Speaker A: Well, Sophie is really good at organizing existing research, so I think she should take the lead on the Literature Review.

Speaker B: I'm happy to do that, and since Liam is doing most of the work setting up our SPSS database, it makes sense for him to draft the Data Analysis section.

Speaker A: I'm fine with that. What about the Methodology? Since we are doing the fieldwork together, maybe we should write the Methodology section as a joint effort?

Speaker B: Yes, that makes sense. We can draft the Methodology together. For the Introduction, I don't mind writing that on my own, which leaves the Discussion and Conclusion for you, Liam.

Speaker A: That sounds like a perfect split.

Speaker C: Excellent. It sounds like you have a solid plan. Just make sure to send me your draft methodology by the end of next week so I can review it before you begin your fieldwork.

This is the end of Part 3.

PART 4

You will hear a university lecturer giving a talk on the history and ecological impact of the introduction of the honeybee to Australia. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Good morning, everyone. Today, we're going to examine the history and ecological impact of the European honeybee in Australia. While honeybees are now a familiar sight across the Australian continent, they are not native to this land. In fact, the first successful introduction of the European honeybee occurred in April of eighteen twenty-two. They were brought over on a ship called the Isabella, primarily to provide early settlers with a reliable source of honey, as well as to pollinate newly introduced European crops.

Speaker A: Initially, these bees were kept in managed hives in coastal areas, but they quickly escaped into the wild, establishing feral colonies. The Australian climate, with its mild winters and abundant eucalyptus trees, proved to be absolutely ideal for them. Eucalyptus trees are a major source of both nectar and pollen, which allowed the feral bee populations to expand rapidly across the continent.

Speaker A: Now, let's look at the ecological impact of these feral honeybees. One of the primary concerns for ecologists is competition with native wildlife. Australia has over two thousand species of native bees, most of which are solitary and do not live in hives. Honeybees are highly aggressive foragers, and their sheer numbers can easily outcompete native bees for nectar. This competition is particularly severe during periods of drought, when nectar resources are scarce.

Speaker A: In addition to native insects, feral honeybees compete with birds and small mammals. Many Australian birds, such as honeyeaters, rely on nectar as their primary food source. When honeybees dominate flowers, these birds are forced to travel much greater distances to find food, which can affect their nesting success. Furthermore, honeybees frequently occupy tree hollows for their hives. These hollows are a limited and vital nesting resource for native animals, especially parrots and gliders. Once a bee colony occupies a hollow, it becomes completely unusable for birds or mammals for many years.

Speaker A: However, the story of the honeybee in Australia is not entirely negative. From an agricultural perspective, their economic contribution is immense. Honeybees are responsible for pollinating a vast array of commercial crops. In fact, about one-third of the food consumed by Australians relies directly or indirectly on honeybee pollination. Crops such as almonds, apples, and cherries are almost entirely dependent on these insects. The almond industry alone, which has grown exponentially in recent years, requires billions of bees each spring to ensure a successful harvest.

Speaker A: Despite their success, honeybees in Australia face significant modern challenges. One of the most pressing threats is the recent arrival of the Varroa mite, a parasite that has devastated bee populations worldwide. For decades, Australia was one of the few places free from this mite, but recent detections have forced biosecurity agencies to implement strict quarantine zones and eradication programs. Climate change is another major challenge, as rising temperatures and extreme weather events alter the flowering times of trees, disrupting the delicate synchronization between bees and their food sources. Understanding these complex relationships is vital as we try to balance agricultural needs with ecological preservation.

This is the end of Part 4.

